

Φοινικίδης ὁ κωμωδιοποιός

Phoenicides the Comic Poet on Feasting and Courtesans

eul_aid: jsi

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Κωμῳδία [Comedy](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Phoenicides was a Greek comic poet active during the 3rd century BCE, in the Hellenistic period. He wrote in the style of New Comedy, a popular form that focused on everyday domestic life, romantic plots, and stock characters rather than the political satire of earlier centuries.

Almost nothing is known about his personal life. He is identified as an Athenian poet in later historical sources, but these details are sparse. Two of his play titles survive: *The Reveller* and *The Slave-Dealer*. Both works are lost, existing only as fragments quoted by later authors.

These fragments, preserved mainly by the writer Athenaeus, offer brief glimpses of typical New Comedy scenes, such as the antics of a flattering parasite. According to modern scholars, Phoenicides is considered a minor figure within the New Comedy tradition, which was dominated by playwrights like Menander. His fragments are nevertheless valuable for helping academics understand the common themes and character types of Hellenistic comedy beyond the few complete plays that survive.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἑταιρῶν Κωμικῶν · [Fragments of Comic Courtesans](#) · 25 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Εὐωχίας · [Fragments on Feasting](#) · 25 passages